

5.5.3 Racing

Games such as *Need For Speed* brought about a craze for racing games like never before. With the ability to drive (and crash) the latest cars, racing games were ideally suited for car lovers. The graphics and sound only improved over the years, and racing games have added the ‘reality’ aspect by making players compete in races and then buy and sell car parts, and even upgrade cars—just like in real life.

It’s obvious that all this interest had to spawn an Open Source racing game sooner or later, which would be developed and played by car lovers...

TORCS

“Gentlemen, Start Your Engines”

TORCS stand for The Open Racing Car Simulator, and, as the name suggests, it’s totally free! Is it as attractive as the latest in the NFS series? Afraid not—it’s a simulator, and is pretty realistic, but not nearly as good looking. The advantage of Open Source games is that they’re playable over any major platform, and thus are quite popular with non-Windows users. TORCS, however, is equally well-known with Windows users, and isn’t system heavy—the installer is just a little over 50 MB.



TORCS is an Open Source racing simulator